



Amending a Job That's Already with Us

When a change needs a fresh certificate, and what to send.

Designs move on. Tell us before the change is built — a certificate covers the plans it was issued against and nothing else, and work on site that doesn't match its approval is the hardest problem to fix later.

TELL US IF ANY OF THIS CHANGES

- ✓ Size — length, width, height, or span
- ✓ Position on the lot, or setback to any boundary
- ✓ Roof pitch, roof sheet, or the framing material
- ✓ Post or column spacing
- ✓ Footing size, depth or type
- ✓ How the structure attaches to the dwelling
- ✓ The engineering, or the engineer

YOU USUALLY DON'T NEED US FOR

- ✗ Colour changes, where nothing structural moves
- ✗ Gutter or downpipe profile, provided discharge is unchanged
- ✗ A different supplier for the same certified product

HOW AN AMENDMENT WORKS

1 You Send Us the Change

Use *Amend a job* in the portal, or email the office: the job number, what's different, revised drawings, and updated engineering if the structure has changed.

2 We Open It as a New Job

Its own reference and its own assessment, linked back to the original. It is not an edit to the certificate you already hold.

3 We Assess the Change

Against the same standards as any other job. If it affects setbacks, bushfire, retained height or fire separation, expect the same questions as first time.

4 A New Certificate Is Issued

Covering the amended design. The original is unchanged and stays valid for the work it described.

5 You Lodge It with the Permit Authority

A new certificate generally means an amended building permit application to the local government. That's their timeframe, not ours — allow for it.



WHAT TO SEND

- ✓ The original job number
- ✓ A plain description of what's changed
- ✓ Revised drawings — site plan and elevations, both showing the change
- ✓ Updated engineering where anything structural has moved
- ✓ A revised BAL assessment if the footprint has moved in a bushfire prone area
- ✓ Whether any of the work has already been built
- ✓ Whether a building permit has already been issued

If you're unsure, ask before you build. A two-minute phone call costs nothing. Rectifying built work that doesn't match its approval can cost a great deal.

TIMING — WHERE A JOB IS WHEN IT CHANGES

WHEN THE CHANGE COMES UP	WHAT HAPPENS
Before we've certified it	Easiest case. Send the revised drawings and we'll assess the current design — no amendment needed, though it may reset where the job sits in the queue.
After we've certified, before the permit is issued	We issue an amended certificate. Get it to the permit authority before they determine the application, or you may end up amending the permit as well.
After the permit is issued	Amended certificate from us, then an amended permit application to the local government. Don't build the change until that's done.
After the work is built	Tell us straight away and say so plainly. Built work that departs from an approval is a different and more difficult problem, and it is far better raised by you than found at inspection.

WHY AN AMENDMENT OPENS A NEW JOB RATHER THAN EDITING THE OLD ONE

A certificate of design compliance is a statutory document. It records that a registered building surveyor assessed a specific set of plans on a specific date and formed the view they complied. That record can't be rewritten after the fact — so an amendment is assessed and certified in its own right, and both certificates remain on file. If anyone later asks what was approved and when, the answer is complete.

Don't build to a change until the amendment is certified. It's the one thing that turns a straightforward amendment into a serious problem. If the work is already underway, stop that element and talk to us first.

